Date: 2026-05-03

notes on papers

snc

- t1

annotations: Belyaev 2023b(1).pdf

paper: Belyaev (2023)

page

note

comment

2

Briefly, c-structure is a phrase structure tree; constraints on possible trees are usually described via context-free rules as in

2

) it has become a universal practice to capture long-distance dependencies through functional uncertainty at fstructure, and the use of empty categories at c-structure has become unnecessary

2

from the point of view of context-free rules, VP and V are atomic symbols that are not related to each other; labeling one of the daughters of NP as N is merely a convention

3

wrong with this structure: an I head cannot be the daughter of NP; the VP cannot be headed by, or even immediately dominate, a Det; an AdvP cannot be headed by a noun.1The principle that prohibits this is called endocentricity; roughly stated, it means that the external distribution of a phrase (e.g. NP) is determined by the category of one and only one of its daughters, the head.

3

enforces endocentricity by introducing the notion of projection and "bar level" and requiring that each non-maximal projection (X0and X′; X″, or XP, is usually assumed to be the maximum level of projection) be dominated by a node belonging to the same category, with the bar level either incremented by one or unchanged. The sisters of c-structure heads (complements, specifiers and adjuncts) have to be maximal projections or non-projecting words (on which see below).

4

Second, X′theory in LFG allows for the following positions: complement (3a), specifier (3b), X′adjunct (3c) and XP adjunct (3d).

4

Specifically, heads may only be stipulated if there is actual lexical material that can occupy them; therefore, even the existence of projections such as CP or IP cannot be automatically assumed for all languages. More abstract projections such as TopicP or ForceP are not usually introduced because there are few suitable candidates for the status of heads of these phrases, and little distributional evidence to argue that their specifiers are distinct structural positions

6

most prominent exception is the exocentric category S.3This category does not have a "head" in the normal sense: it can be "headed" by a verb, but also by an adjective or another nonverbal predicate; this is why the term S is used instead of, for example, VP. The category S is most extensively used in nonconfigurational languages

7

as a result, X′theory, understood purely in terms of c-structure, is little else than a system of labeling nodes which allows us to generalize endocentricity at constituent structure level.

7

lexicalism implies that the features of individual syntactic elements (morphemes and word-forms) as well as their subcategorization frames are determined in the lexicon, and cannot be modified in the syntax (such as by promoting the direct object in a passive construction)

8

individual words that are constructed from different blocks and according to different rules than syntactic constituents.5Thus, the distinction between morphology and syntax in LFG is viewed as fundamental

8

This understanding of lexicalism is more formally termed lexical integrity

annotations: Boerjars 2020 LFG Annual Review 6_1.pdf

paper: Börjars (2020)

page

note

comment

2

crucial idea underpinning Lexical-Functional Grammar (LFG) is that a linguistic element of any size—a word, a phrase, or a sentence—is associated with different types of linguistic information, for instance, information about prosody, about category and constituency, about grammatical relations, and about semantics

2

"the formal model of LFG is not a syntactic theory in the linguistic sense. Rather, it is an architecture for syntactic theory

2

It is a parallel correspondence model because the different dimensions of linguistic information are represented separately but are connected by well-defined principles of correspondence, or mappings.

2

c-structure (constituent and category)

3

C-structure captures information about constituency and categories

6

Oblique argument

prepositional argument, obligatoire(..)(..)gehen1: nach, in > oblig.(..)gehen2: walken,laufen, gehen (mit stöckern): nicht oblig.

6

Adjunct

not necessary specification, vom prädikat nicht verlangt

Belyaev, Oleg. 2023. "Core Concepts of LFG." *Handbook of Lexical Functional Grammar* (Berlin), November, 23–96. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.10185936.

Börjars, Kersti. 2020. “Lexical-Functional Grammar: An Overview.” *Annual Review of Linguistics* 6 (1): 155–72. https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev-linguistics-062419-125014.

[redacted]